

Who Were You Before Them?

Reclaiming Your God-Given Identity

"We are God's handiwork, created in Christ Jesus." — Ephesians 2:10

KEY CONCEPTS

1 Identity erosion is a strategy, not a side effect

Narcissists chip away at your sense of self deliberately — whether consciously or not. Your opinions get corrected. Your tastes get mocked. Your needs get pathologised. Your achievements get minimised. This is not accidental. A person without a solid sense of self is much easier to control.

2 Imago Dei: you are still in there

You were made in the image of God — creative, curious, feeling, relational, purposeful. That image cannot be destroyed by another person's abuse. It can be buried, suppressed, and forgotten — but it is waiting. Ephesians 2:10 says you are God's handiwork. That wasn't cancelled by what happened to you.

3 Reclaiming yourself is an act of worship

Getting back the things you stopped doing, wearing, saying, or believing — not because someone else thinks they're valuable, but because you do — is an act of worship. Delight is not selfish. Joy is not self-indulgent. They are part of the abundant life Jesus said He came to bring.

THIS WEEK'S PRACTICE

Before and after: Make two columns. 'Before this relationship, I was someone who...' and 'During this relationship, I stopped...' The gap between those two lists is your roadmap back to yourself.

YOUR REFLECTION

'I am God's handiwork. What was buried in me was not destroyed. I am finding my way back to myself.'

YOUR NOTES & JOURNAL SPACE

WANT TO GO DEEPER?

The full community has an Identity Mosaic Builder — a beautiful interactive tool where you place words, qualities, and colors onto a canvas of who God made you to be. It's one of the most healing things we do together. Join Reclaim Your Self at \$27/month.

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